Rwanda National Financial Inclusion Roadmap 2026–2030: From Access to Meaningful Usage Leading to Financial Health.

Republic of Rwanda

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List of abbreviations

Abbreviation	Full Meaning
NBR	National Bank of Rwanda
MINECOFIN	Ministry of Finance and Economic Planning
MINAGRI	Ministry of Agriculture and Animal Resources
MINICOM	Ministry of Trade and Industry
MIGEPROF	Ministry of Gender and Family Promotion
MOYA	Ministry of Youth and Arts
MINALOC	Ministry of Local Government
MINICT	Ministry of Information Communication Technology & Innovation
MINEDUC	Ministry of Education
MINEMA	Ministry of Emergency Management
MINIJUST	Ministry of Justice
RRA	Rwanda Revenue Authority
NIDA	National Identification Agency
LODA	Local Administrative Entities Development Agency
RCA	Rwanda Cooperative Agency
RAB	Rwanda Agriculture Board
NAEB	National Agricultural Export Development Board
REG	Rwanda Energy Group
NESA	National Examination and School Inspection Authority
RDB	Rwanda Development Board
FSPs	Financial Service Providers
MFIs	Microfinance Institutions

SACCO / D-SACCO	Savings and Credit Cooperative / District SACCO
EMI (s)	Electronic Money Issuers
PSP (s)	Payment Service Providers
RSWITCH	Rwanda National Digital Payments Switch
RBA	Rwanda Bankers Association
NUDOR	National Union of Disability Organizations in Rwanda
AMIR	Association of Microfinance Institutions of Rwanda
ASSAR	Association of Insurers in Rwanda
CRB	Credit Reference Bureau
CMA	Capital Markets Authority
BRD	Development Bank of Rwanda
RNIT	Rwanda National Investment Trust
RSE	Rwanda Stock Exchange
RFL	Rwanda Finance Limited
AFR	Access to Finance Rwanda
UNDP	United Nations Development Programme
WBG	World Bank Group
WFP	World Food Programme
UNHCR	United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees
NGO(s)	Non-Governmental Organization(s)
NFIR	National Financial Inclusion Roadmap
NFES	National Financial Education Strategy
FinCap	Financial Capability Survey
FIS	Financial Inclusion Secretariat

Intumwa	NBR's consumer-protection chatbot
AML	Anti-Money Laundering
NPL	Non-Performing Loans
DFS	Digital Financial Services
API	Application Programming Interface
CBDC	Central Bank Digital Currency
TPPs	Third Party Providers
LTSS / EjoHeza	Long-Term Savings Scheme — Rwanda's voluntary pension scheme
CBHI	Community-Based Health Insurance
SCG(s)	Savings and Credit Groups
U-SACCO	Umurenge Savings and Credit Cooperative
MSMEs	Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises
Agri-MSMEs	Agriculture-focused Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises
RYAF	Rwanda Youth in Agribusiness Forum
P2P	Person-to-Person payments
P2B	Person-to-Business payments
P2G	Person-to-Government payments
B2B	Business-to-Business payments

1. Introduction

Financial inclusion is widely recognized as a critical driver of economic growth, poverty reduction, and national development. An inclusive and well-functioning financial system mobilizes savings for investment, lowers transaction costs, and allocates resources efficiently. In doing so, it supports employment creation, stimulates economic growth, and enhances household welfare. By enabling individuals and businesses to manage risks, absorb shocks, and accumulate assets over time, financial inclusion strengthens both individual resilience and national prosperity.

Rwanda's Vision 2050 places wealth creation and improved living standards at the center of national development. It calls for moving beyond living "check by check" or "harvest by harvest" toward a society that creates, manages, and sustains wealth. Achieving this ambition requires a stable, sound, and inclusive financial ecosystem that is sufficiently deep and diversified to mobilize and allocate resources in line with the country's long-term development needs. Emphasis is placed on addressing persistent gaps affecting youth, women, and rural populations.

In alignment with Vision 2050, the National Strategy for Transformation (NST2) underscores inclusive growth and citizen-centered development as national priorities. NST2 mandates the implementation of the National Financial Inclusion Roadmap (NFIR) as a key instrument to expand access to and meaningful usage of financial services across the country.

Developed through a collaborative stakeholder process, the NFIR provides a coordinated framework to guide government institutions, regulators, and private sector actors in advancing financial inclusion. Jointly led by the National Bank of Rwanda (NBR) and the Ministry of Finance and Economic Planning (MINECOFIN), the roadmap outlines actionable policy priorities aimed at ensuring that all Rwandan adults can access and actively use appropriate, affordable, and sustainable financial services that enhance financial well-being and contribute to inclusive economic transformation.

2. Rationale for Developing the NFIR

Financial inclusion is a foundational enabler of Rwanda's transition toward an upper middle-income country by 2035 and a high-income country by 2050. Achieving these milestones requires a productive and inclusive economy in which citizens are empowered not only to access financial services, but to use them effectively to save, invest, and build resilience.

While Rwanda has made significant progress with formal financial inclusion reaching 92% and overall inclusion at 96%, these achievements still mask important structural challenges. Financial inclusion growth has been driven predominantly by mobile money, which remains largely concentrated in payments and remittances. While additional services such as microloans are emerging, their depth and scale remain insufficient to significantly strengthen financial health outcomes.

Furthermore, disparities persist beneath the headline figures. While the overall gender gap in access has narrowed to approximately 4 percentage points, the gap widens to over 10 percentage points when examining savings, credit uptake, and financial health indicators. Banking penetration has also remained stagnant at 22%, despite banks holding more than two-thirds of total financial sector assets. This disconnect highlights the need to better translate sectoral strength into inclusive, broad-based impact.

These realities underscore that financial inclusion can no longer be measured solely by account ownership or access. The next phase of reform must prioritize meaningful usage and financial health, ensuring that financial services enable individuals to manage risks, invest productively, and accumulate assets over time.

While financial well-being is influenced by broader socio-economic factors including income levels, employment opportunities, and social protection the financial sector plays a catalytic role. Effective regulation, appropriate product design, and targeted interventions can significantly enhance resilience.

This National Financial Inclusion Roadmap (NFIR) therefore marks a deliberate shift from access to impact. It consolidates past achievements while focusing on closing persistent usage gaps and strengthening financial health outcomes. Anchored in Rwanda's national development vision, the NFIR provides a strategic framework to guide coordinated action by public and private stakeholders, ensuring that financial inclusion contributes meaningfully to economic empowerment and sustainable prosperity.

3. National Financial Inclusion Roadmap Vision

"To build a financially inclusive Rwanda where all adults and their enterprises have seamless access to and regularly use a wide range of affordable, appropriate, and sustainable financial services that meet their diverse needs, strengthen their financial health, and improve their overall well-being".

By moving beyond access to meaningful usage, the NFIR will drive wealth creation, resilience, and shared prosperity, directly contributing to Rwanda's Vision 2050 ambition of building a society that no longer lives paycheck to paycheck or harvest to harvest, but instead accumulates wealth and financial security.

4. Definition of financial inclusion in Rwanda

Financial inclusion is achieved when individuals and businesses have effective access to a wide range of useful and affordable financial products and services that consumers are willing to pay for, from formal institutions, which meet their needs, delivered in a responsible and sustainable way.

In Rwanda, financial inclusion was previously defined considering both formal and informal financial services. Formal financial services are those provided by financial institutions regulated by the National Bank of Rwanda. These include Banks, Micro Finance Institutions (PLCs), Savings and Credit Cooperatives (SACCOs), Insurers, e-money issuers, Payments Service Providers (PSPs), pension providers and Non-Deposit Taking Financial Service Providers.

On the other hand, informal financial services are provided by institutions that are not regulated by the National Bank of Rwanda. These include informal savings and credit cooperatives, ibimina, etc.

However, it is worth noting that this roadmap refines the definition of financial inclusion to focus exclusively on formal financial services. This shift reflects Rwanda's significant progress toward achieving universal access of 96% financial inclusion as per Finscope Survey 2024. Additionally, as access is no longer the primary barrier to financial inclusion, the strategic priority is transitioning from basic inclusion to meaningful usage where individuals and businesses actively utilize quality, regulated financial services in ways that strengthen resilience and long-term wellbeing leading to financial health.

5. Rwanda's Financial Inclusion Journey at a Glance (2008–2024) with focus on the demand side.

Over the past 16 years, Rwanda has made remarkable progress in advancing financial inclusion. Formal financial inclusion increased from 21% in 2008 to 92% in 2024, reflecting the country's commitment to building an inclusive financial sector that leaves no one behind.

This journey has been shaped by two major drivers:

- Savings and Credit Cooperatives, which played a central role in extending financial services up to 2015.
- Mobile money services, which have driven expansion from 2016 onwards, transforming access and usage across the country.

5.1 Key Achievements as per Finscope Surveys:

- **Overall inclusion (formal and informal)** grew from 48% in 2008 to 96% in 2024, corresponding to 7.8 million adults accessing financial services.
- **Formal inclusion** rose sharply from 21% in 2008 to 92% in 2024, representing 7.5 million adults.
- **Informal services** remain relevant, with 72% of adults still relying on them in 2024 (down slightly from 78% in 2020), pointing to continued demand for tailored solutions.
- **Mobile money** usage expanded from 34% in 2016 to 77% in 2024, confirming its role as the leading driver of inclusion.
- **D-SACCO usage** peaked at 36% in 2020 but decreased to 28% in 2024, reflecting a gradual shift toward digital services.
- Uptake of **formal savings** rose from 36% in 2012 to 59% in 2024, while **formal borrowing** grew from 10% in 2008 to 24% in 2024.
- **Insurance coverage** excluding Community Based Health Insurance(CBHI) expanded from 3% in 2008 to 27% in 2024, while **pension coverage** increased from 7% in 2020 to 25% in 2024.

- The proportion of **financially excluded adults** declined dramatically, from 52% in 2008 to only 4% in 2024.
- The **gender gap** in overall inclusion narrowed from 15% in 2012 to 4% in 2024, marking a major step toward gender equality.

5.2 Emerging Challenges

While Rwanda is approaching universal access, **usage remains relatively low**, limiting the overall impact on people's financial health and well-being. According to the 2024 FinScope survey:

- 77% of adults hold a transactional account, but there is still a **9% gender gap** (73% of women vs. 83% of men).
- The share of **banked adults has stagnated at 22%** since 2020, despite banks holding **67.5% of financial sector assets**. By comparison, pensions hold 15.7%, insurers 8.9%, microfinance institutions 7%, and other institutions 0.9% (NBR Annual Report, 2023–2024).

This structure highlights the need for increased **usage of bank and other formal services**, alongside greater innovation to ensure financial products are **affordable, accessible, and responsive to people's needs**.

Table 1: Rwanda Financial Inclusion Journey from 2008 to 2024

Indicator	Year				
	2008	2012	2016	2020	2024
Overall inclusion (formal and informal)	48%	72%	89%	93%(7M)	96% (7.8M)
Formal inclusion	21%	42%	68%	77% (5.4M)	92% (7.5M)
Banked	14%	23%	26%	22% (1.6M)	22% (1.8M)
Other formal	7%	33%	65%	75%	70%
Informal overall	39%	58%	72%	78%	72%
U-SACCOs	NA	22%	34%	36%	28%
Mobile Money			34%	61%	77%
Informal only	26%	30%	21%	16%	4%
Formal saving	NA	36%	49%	54%	59%
Formal Borrowing	10%	9%	15%	22%	24%
Insurance uptake (excluding CBHI)	3%	7%	9%	17%	27%
Pension	NA			7%	25%
Gender gap in overall inclusion	NA	15%	11%	7%	4%
Financially Excluded	52%	28%	11%	7%	4%

6. The shift towards measuring Financial Inclusion using supply side data

Rwanda has achieved a remarkable milestone, with over 90% formal financial inclusion according to the FinScope survey (demand-side data).

However, while access levels are high, active usage remains comparatively low, limiting the full impact of financial inclusion on household resilience, productivity, and overall financial well-being. Recognizing this gap, the strategic focus is shifting from measuring access alone to promoting and tracking meaningful usage at the individual level.

To support this transition, the National Bank of Rwanda (NBR) has introduced a complementary approach to measuring financial inclusion using supply-side data reported by regulated financial institutions. This approach enables more frequent, granular, and real-time monitoring of inclusion trends.

NBR's financial inclusion dashboard aggregates data by gender, age, and geographic location, allowing for more targeted policy responses. The system considers only individual customers, using the National Identification Number (NIN) as a unique identifier to eliminate duplication across institutions. Importantly, measurement focuses exclusively on active customers, ensuring that reported inclusion reflects meaningful engagement rather than dormant accounts.

This evolution in measurement methodology represents a deliberate and forward-looking shift—from counting access points to assessing active participation in the financial system. By updating and publishing financial inclusion data on a weekly basis, NBR enhances transparency, strengthens accountability, and supports evidence-based policymaking aimed at advancing financial health.

Below is a highlight of financial inclusion levels as of end June 2025.

6.1 Access to Financial Services and Products, and Access Channels

The data demonstrates that overall financial inclusion has reached a high level, indicating broad access to financial services among the adult population. Transactional accounts represent the most widespread form of financial access, deposit accounts and savings showcasing moderate levels of account ownership among formal financial institutions. However, access to credit from formal financial institutions and insurance products remains considerably lower, suggesting significant opportunities for expanding these financial services.

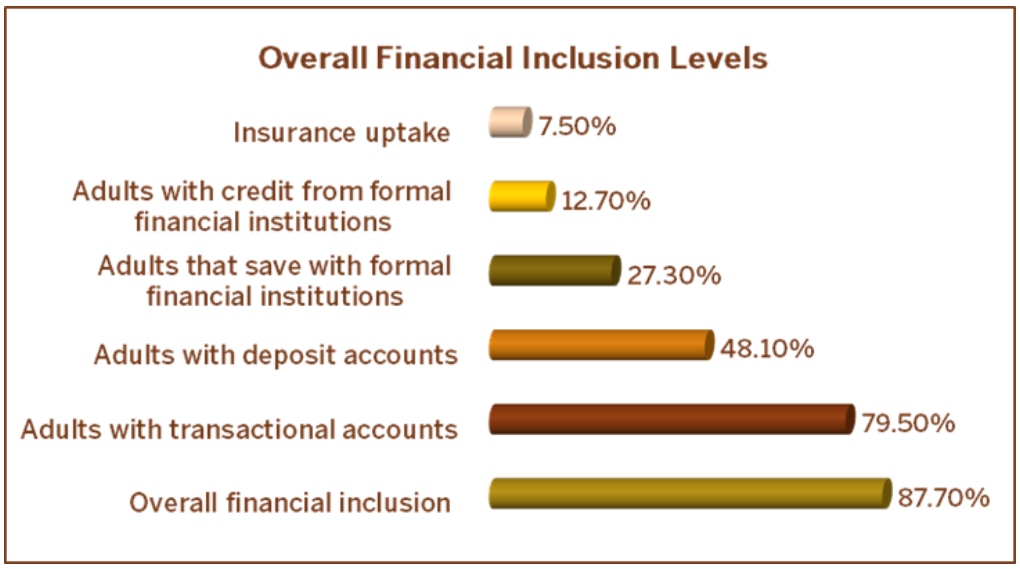


Figure 1: Overall Financial Inclusion Levels

This section examines two key dimensions of financial inclusion, access to and usage of financial services, using supply-side data segmented by gender and age. It highlights trends in access for banks, MFIs, SACCOs, and EMIs, and explores financial service usage across banks, MFIs, SACCOs, EMIs, insurance, and pension providers. The data within this section uses the NID (national identification) as a unique identifier to avoid duplication.

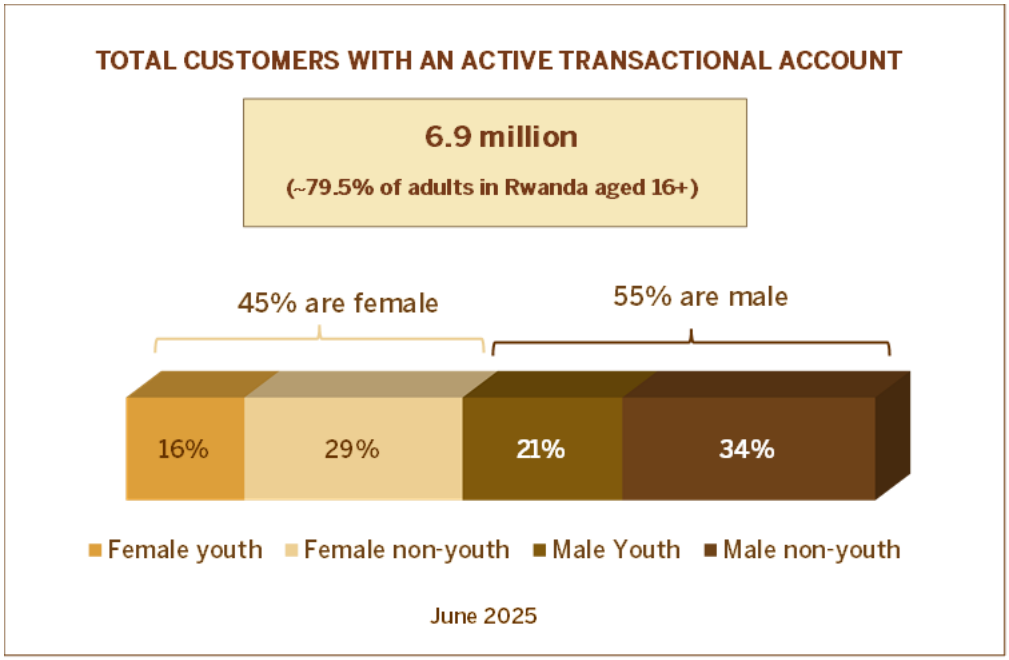


Figure 2: Total Customers with an active transactional account

While Rwanda has achieved impressive financial penetration with nearly 80% of the adult population holding active transactional accounts based on supply side data, this success masks a significant gender disparity. Despite women comprising majority (52%) of the population, they hold only 45% of these accounts compared to 55% held by men, with adult women being particularly underrepresented. Although younger generations show a more balanced engagement, and mobile money increasing access, the data indicates that Rwanda's high overall financial inclusion rate has not yet translated into equitable participation, revealing a gap between formal access and meaningful financial engagement for women.

6.1.1 Financial Service Access Points

Rwanda has made great progress in providing financial services by creating a large network of mobile money agents, rather than relying on traditional bank branches. As a result, local agents are now far more accessible than bank branches, enabling people to manage their finances conveniently within their own communities. Rwanda's experience shows that creating easy, widespread access is more impactful than investing in large, centralized banking infrastructure.

Table 2: Financial Service Access Points

	Banks	MFIs	EMIs	Total
Branches per total adults	419	383	N/A	802
Branches per 100,000 adults **	5	4	N/A	9
Agents per total adults	2,522	216	170,078	2,522
Agents per 100,000 adults **	29	2	1,958	29

*100,000 adults as per IMF baseline for measuring access

Rwanda's mobile money agent network demonstrates a clear urban-rural divide. While the country has achieved impressive nationwide financial access, agent distribution is heavily skewed toward urban centers where customer density and transaction volumes are highest.

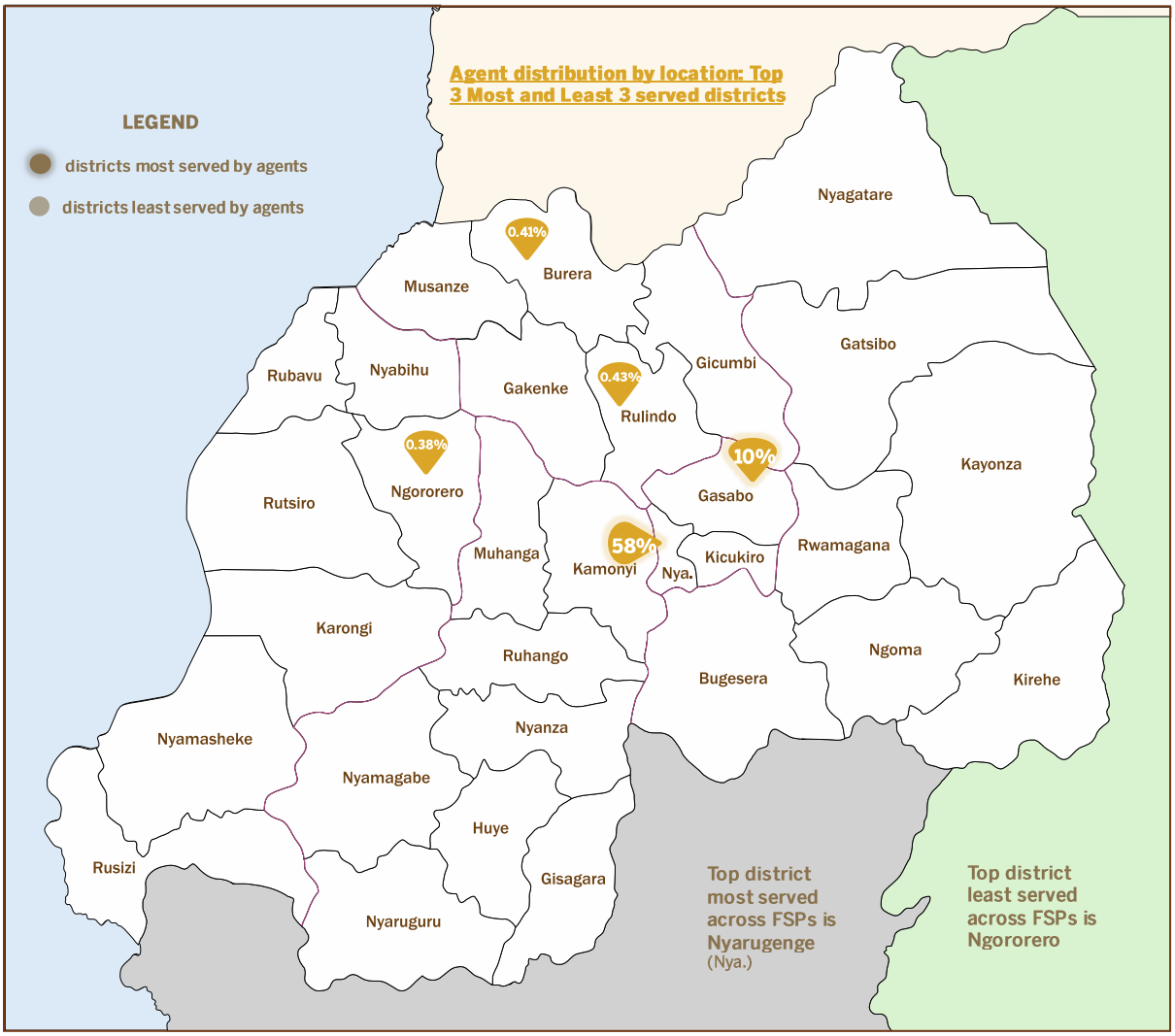


Figure 3: Agent distribution by location

6.2 Transaction Accounts and Digital Financial Services

6.2.1 E-Wallets Dominate Transaction Account Penetration

A transactional account is defined as either a current account or an e-wallet (mobile money wallet). With 68.5% of the adult population owning e-wallets and 5% owning bank accounts, mobile money remains a key driver of financial inclusion in Rwanda. Bank accounts serve as a critical gateway to deeper financial inclusion enabling access to a broader range advanced financial services such as loans, insurance, and pension, among others, that support long-term financial security and resilience.

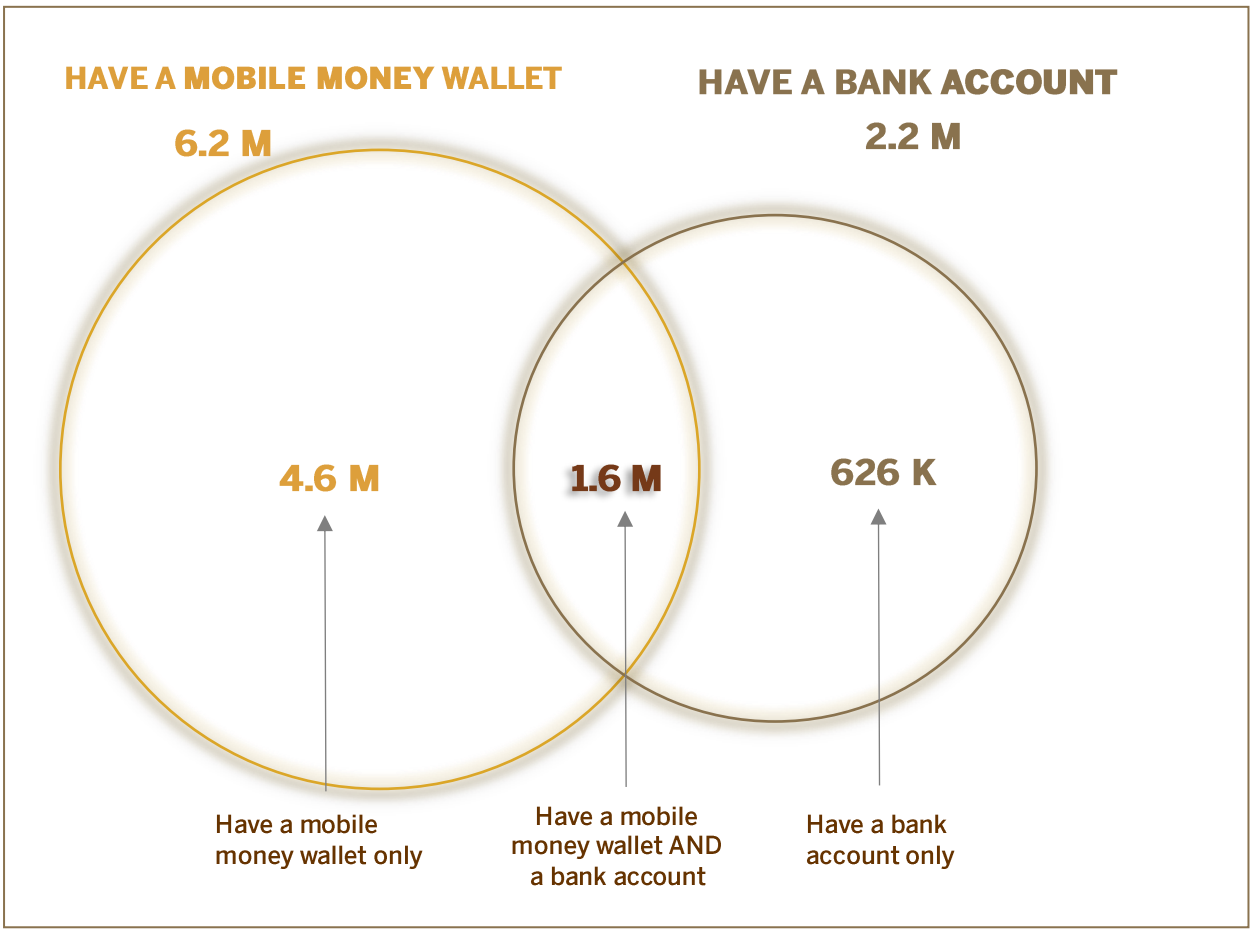


Figure 4: Mobile money wallet vs bank accounts penetration

This section details the number of customers who hold active accounts across the sectors. Customers with at least one transactional account are approximately 6.96 million (approximately 80% of adults in Rwanda).

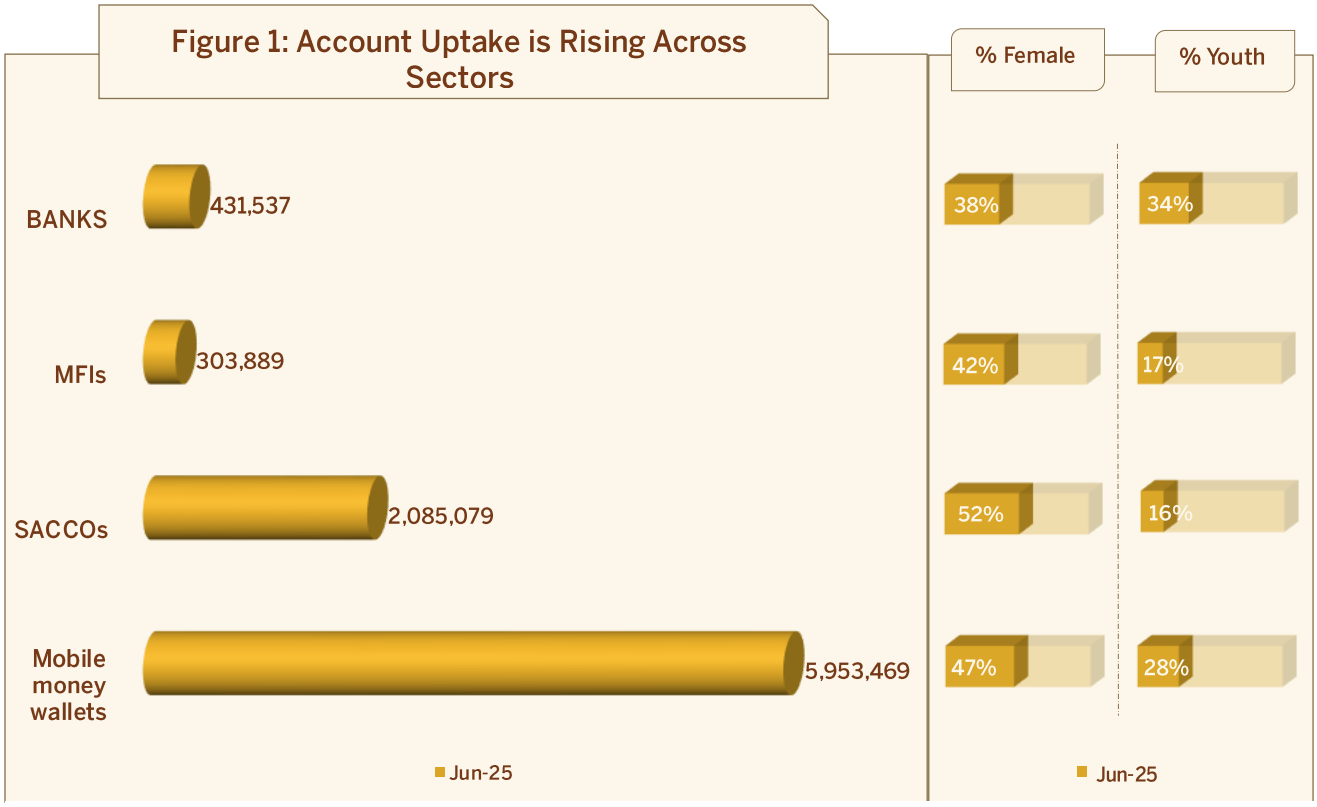


Figure 5: Account uptake across sector

On average, 44% of customers of formal financial service providers are female, while 24% are youth (aged 16 to 30). Mobile money is increasingly becoming a savings and credit channel.

Women representing a significant 52% of the total population in Rwanda, primarily utilize SACCOs and mobile money, and these sectors reach 62% and 24% of all adult women respectively. Youth comprising 45% of Rwanda's total adult population favor mobile money, which serves over 43%. This segment has low participation in SACCOs (9%), banks (4%), and MFIs (1%).

6.2.2 Other Digital Financial Services

Mobile money is the engine of Rwanda's digital financial inclusion, serving 5.95 million adults (69.5%) and transforming access into a personal, everyday experience. This success offers a platform for deepening engagement with broader digital financial services including internet and mobile banking as detailed below.

However, structural barriers remain limited digital literacy and gaps in smartphone availability and connectivity reach. These challenges create a digital divide, leaving customers reliant on mobile money services while excluding them from advanced services like mobile and internet banking, among others. Bridging this gap demands moving beyond account ownership to prioritizing targeted education, improved infrastructure, and innovative delivery models to ensure equitable access and meaningful usage across all regions.

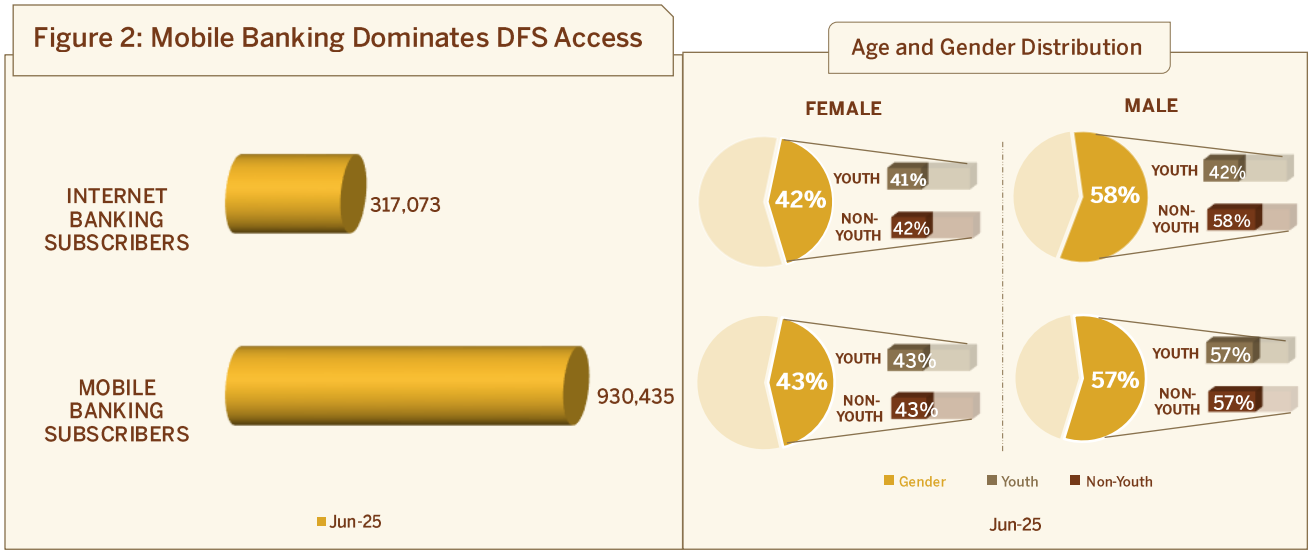


Figure 6: Digital financial services access

However, beneath this success lies a persistent gender gap that technology alone has not solved. Men form a distinct majority of users across both mobile and internet banking, a consistent pattern that points to deeper, non-technical barriers. This imbalance suggests that while mobile platforms have made access more convenient, they have not fully overcome the systemic social and economic hurdles that limit women's financial autonomy and economic participation.

6.3 Access to Financial Services and Products

6.3.1 Customer-Owned Savings Accounts

This section analyzes savings data to assess formal account ownership and highlight critical gaps, also highlighting gender and age-related disparities. According to June 2025, male savings account holders outnumber females by 10%. In addition, non-youth collectively account for 63% of all active savers (29% female non-youth, 34% male non-youth) while youth account holders account for only 37% (16% female youth, 21% male youth). These statistics underscore persistent gaps per gender and age in formal savings participation, where women and young people, remain significantly less included.

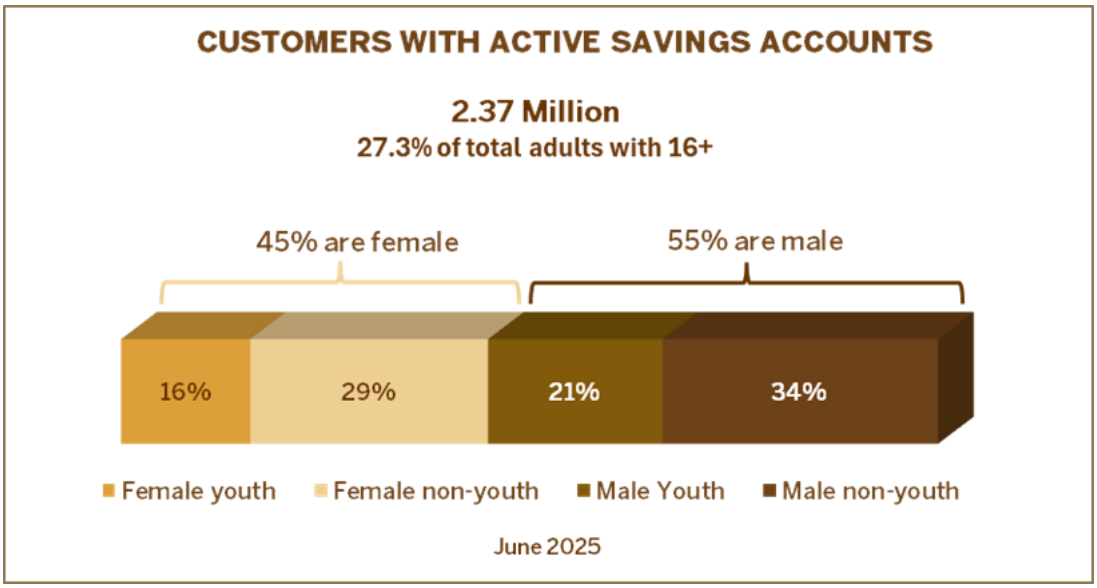


Figure 7: Customer with active savings accounts

Banks are the primary driver of savings penetration serving 21% of the total adult population. Among adult women, 17% hold savings accounts in banks, while the corresponding figure for youth is 21%.

A significant 62% of female savers prefer MFIs, with 41% opting for banks compared to male savers. Conversely, despite representing only 48% of the adult population, men exhibit a stronger tendency to save, with 59% utilizing banks and 38% of total male adult population using MFIs.

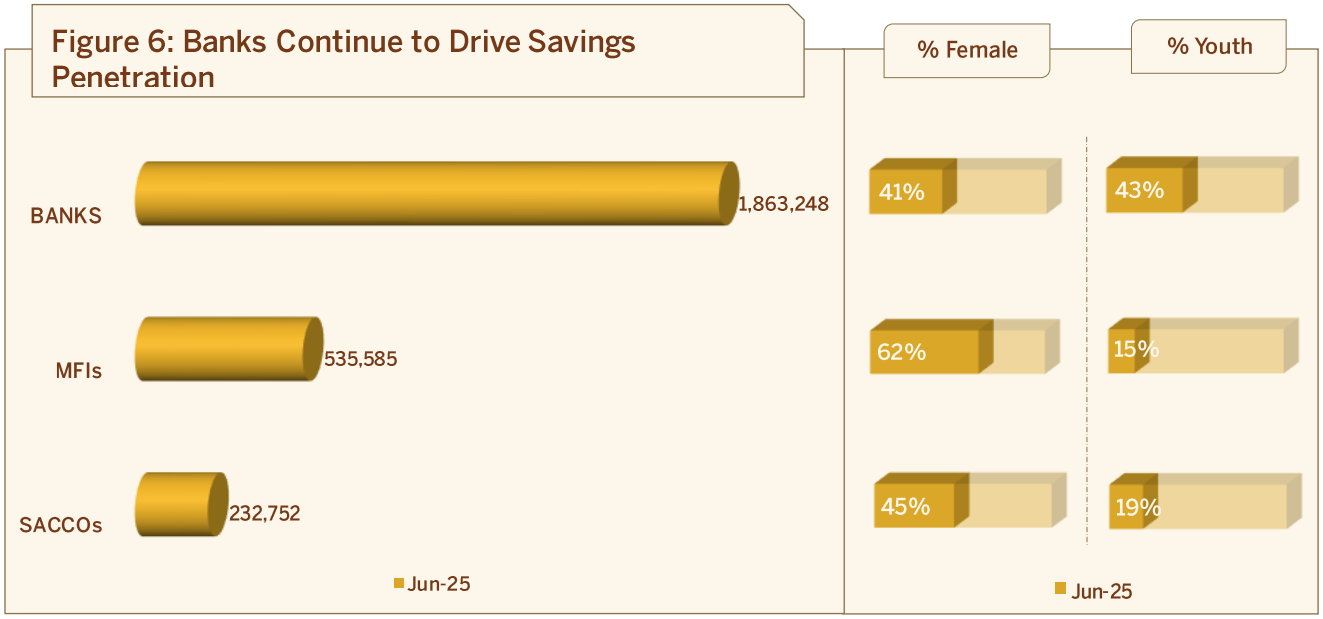


Figure 8: Saving penetration per financial institution

This disparity between population representation and savings behavior underscores a notable gender gap in savings engagement, where men demonstrate a higher tendency to save across the formal financial sector at 51%.

6.3.2 Credit account holders in the financial sector

As of June 2025, the state of credit provision reached 1.10 million customers, while a significant number, only represents about 12.7% of the total adult population (16+). This low penetration highlights a major challenge in financial inclusion, indicating that most adults, nearly 87.3%, remain without formal credit access.

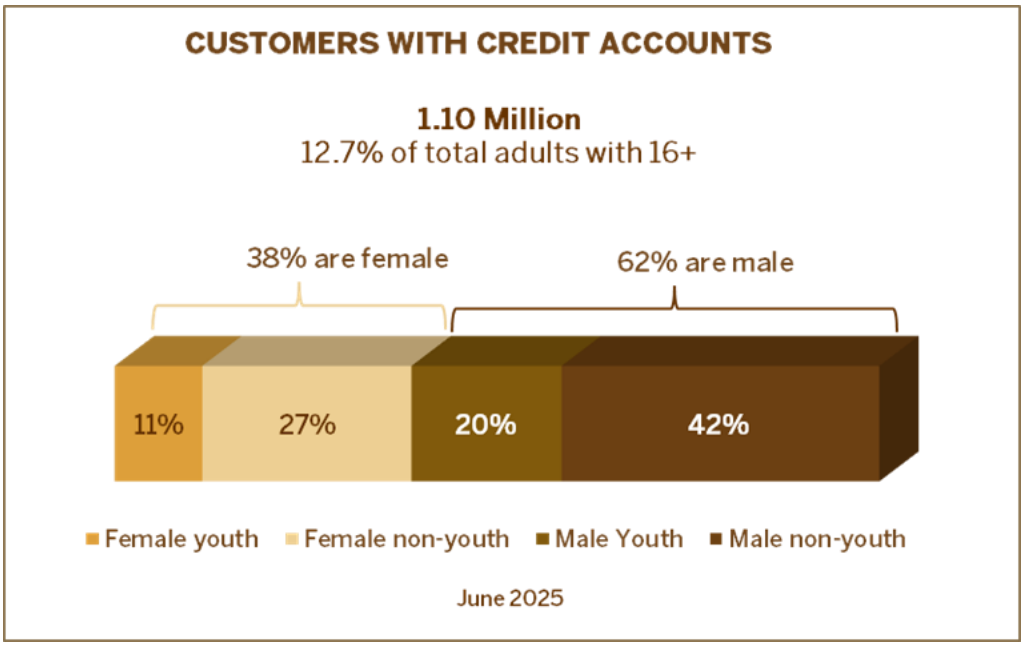


Figure 9: Credit account holders (by gender and age) in the financial sector

For the customers who are included, the average customer holds 2.15 credit accounts. However, the largest segment of customers included (64.5%), still holds a single credit account.

A critical barrier to equitable financial inclusion is the significant disparity in access along gender and age segments whereby male customers account for 62% of all credit account holders compared to only 38% for females, underscoring a pronounced gender gap. This issue is compounded when considering age, the most underserved group is female youth, representing a mere 11% of the customer base. This powerful intersection of being young and female places this group at the greatest disadvantage in accessing formal credit though also male non-youth hold the share of 42%.

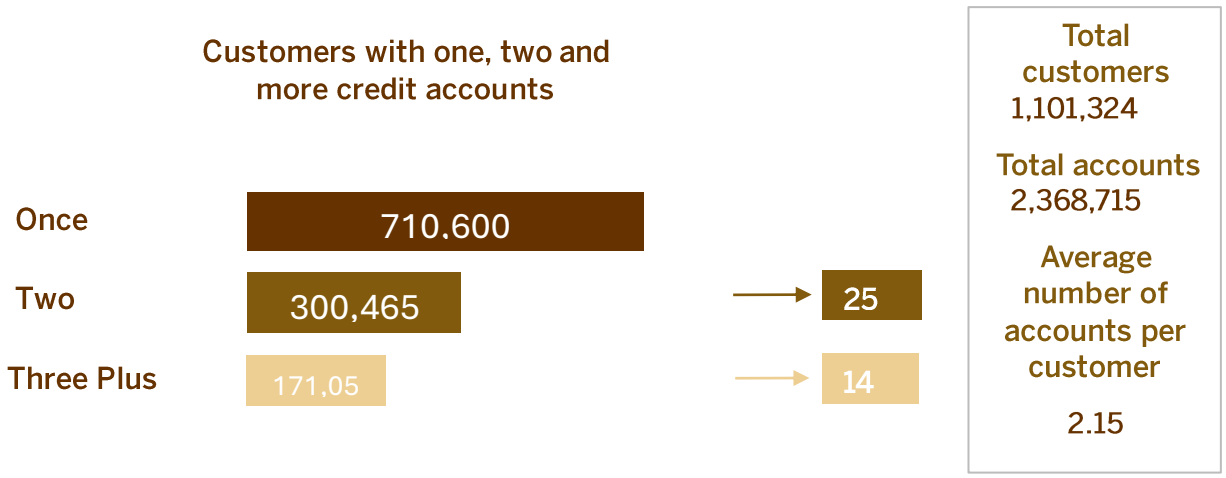


Figure 10: Credit account holders in the financial sector

To advance financial inclusion, there is an urgent need to broaden the reach of credit products to the 87.3% of the adult population that are still excluded and to address the remaining gender gap in access to credit.

Among the adult population in Rwanda, 12.7% accessed credit across different financial institutions. Banks dominate the credit market, serving a larger share of borrowers (9%).

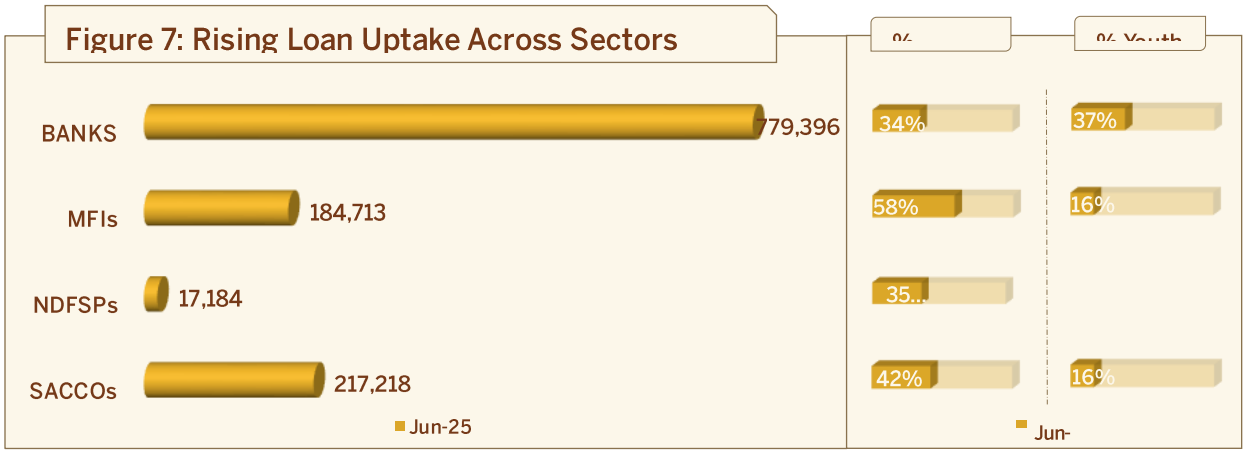


Figure 11: Loan update across sectors

Banks have a larger borrower base overall, but MFIs are significant in extending credit to women, accounting for approximately three fifths of their lending. The smaller role of Non-Deposit Taking Financial Service Providers (NDFSPs) indicates that alternative financing options remain limited in scale, with only 2% of granted loans in comparison to other FSPs.

The top five categories of credit provisions are digital loans, personal loans, working capital credit, commercial mortgage, residential mortgage loans, altogether, hold 98% of all the credit categories, with digital and personal loans accounting for 58% and 33%, respectively.

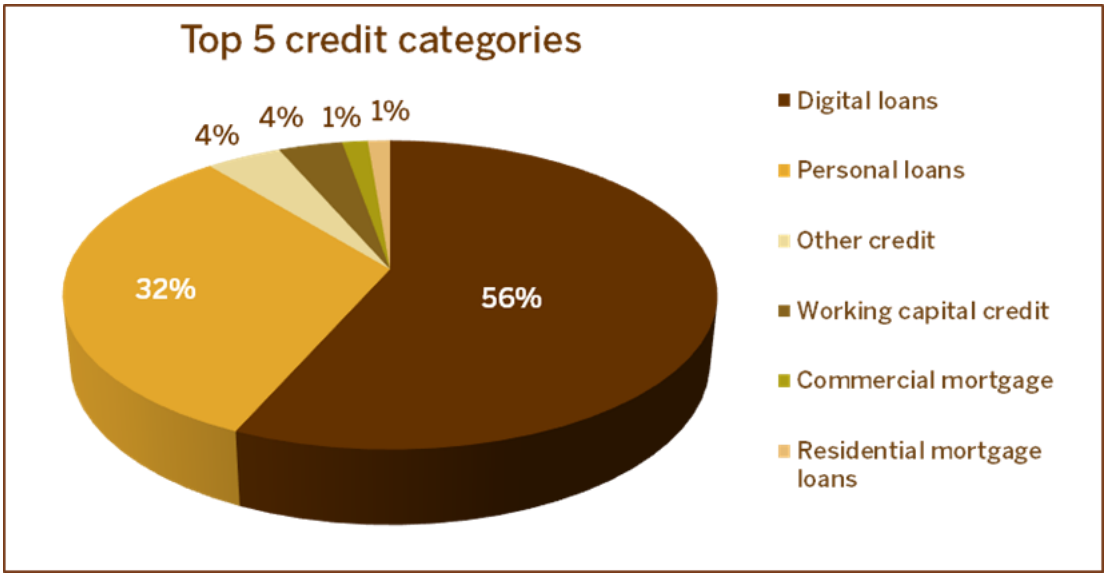


Figure 12: Top credit categories

Only 34% of transactional account holders across all financial services have successfully saved, while just 16% have accessed credit.

6.3.3 Insurance penetration

The total number of policyholders enrolled across all insurance schemes in Rwanda stands at more than 600,000 representing approximately 7.5% of the country's total adult population. This coverage reflects the gradual progress toward expanding insurance access within the national financial inclusion agenda. Among these policyholders, 31% are female, and 29% are youth, indicating the lower engagement from these key demographic groups. On average, each policyholder maintains two insurance policies, suggesting a moderate level of product diversification among insured individuals.

However, insurance penetration remains unevenly distributed across the country, with a heavy concentration in urban districts. Specifically, Nyarugenge and Gasabo districts collectively account for 426,000 policyholders, representing 65% of the total insurance market share. Nyarugenge alone accounts for 224,957 policyholders (approximately 34%), while Gasabo contributes 201,010 policyholders (about 31%). These figures highlight the urban-centric nature of insurance uptake, which poses ongoing challenges for broadening distribution and accessibility across more rural and remote districts in Rwanda.

7. Desired Outcomes of the National Financial Inclusion Roadmap

The five desired outcomes of Rwanda's National Financial Inclusion Roadmap (2026–2030) reflect the shift from access to meaningful usage, with the goal of strengthening financial health for all Rwandans.

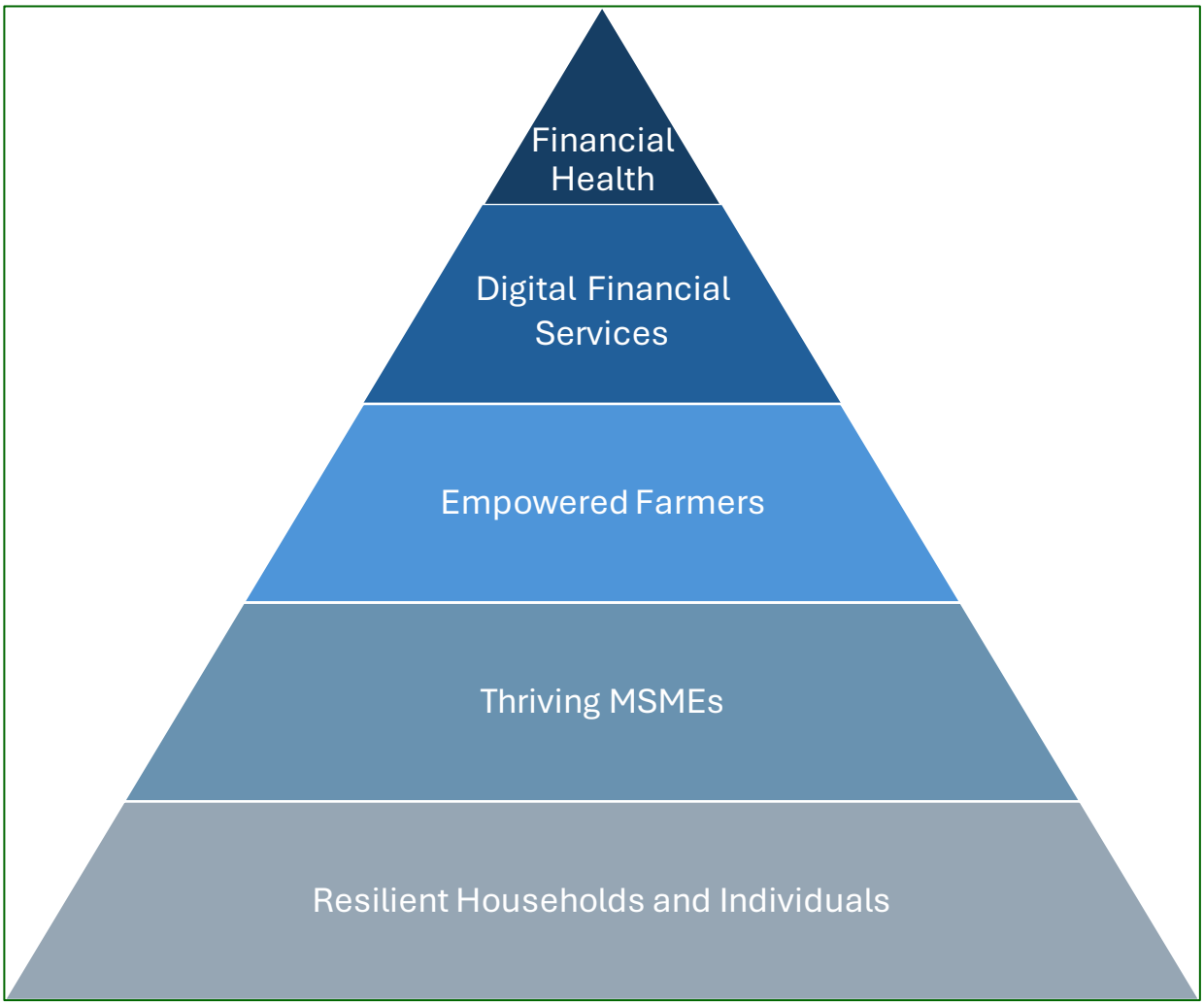


Figure 13: Desired Outcomes of the National Financial Inclusion Roadmap

The pyramid below illustrates the five desired NFIR outcomes. It demonstrates the progress from foundational outcomes (households and farmers), through growth drivers (MSMEs and digital financial services), towards the ultimate goal of financial health for all.

1. **Enhanced Financial Resilience for Individuals and Households:** Rwandans effectively use financial services such as savings, insurance, and digital payments to manage income shocks, build emergency reserves, and plan for long-term goals. This leads to improved financial stability, greater resilience, and reduced vulnerability to external shocks.

2. **Increased MSME access to finance:** Micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs) access and leverage tailored financial products to expand operations, invest in innovation, and improve efficiency. This drives business growth, profitability, and job creation, contributing to Rwanda's broader economic transformation.

3. **Access to finance and Resilience of Farmers:** Farmers access affordable and resilient financial solutions including agricultural loans, crop and livestock insurance, and digital payment platforms such as Credit Market Infrastructure. These services enable them to adopt modern techniques, mitigate climate risks, and strengthen productivity and resilience

4. **Expansion of digital financial services:** Individuals, households, farmers, and MSMEs actively use secure, affordable, and user-friendly digital financial platforms for transactions, savings, credit, and payments. This accelerates convenience, efficiency, and inclusion across both rural and urban areas.

5. **Strengthened Financial Health Through Responsible Finance:** All population segments benefit from transparent, fair, and consumer-focused financial services. Greater financial literacy, stronger consumer protection, and responsible financial behaviors enable better decision-making, sustainable financial health, and long-term well-being.

The achievement of this vision and its supporting objectives will be enabled by a wide range of activities, organized into five pillars with 23 interventions.

8. Summary of NFIR pillars and interventions

5 pillars of the NFIR ,23 interventions

1.Resilience and money management for individuals and households	2.MSMEs access to finance for investment	3.Access to finance for investment and resilience of farmers	4.Expansion of digital financial services	5.Strengthen Financial Health
Support informal savings and credit groups	Stock taking of existing interventions	Strengthen the Agri finance data/information environment	Increase Usage of Digital Financial Services	Promote Financial Literacy and Capability
Enhance Services from SACCOs and Microfinance Institutions	Broaden available range of products / providers	Develop an agriculture lending infrastructure	Promote Open Finance and Data Sharing Frameworks	Strengthen Financial Consumer Protection Frameworks
Strengthen MFIs to provide more options for customers in rural areas	Capacity support to MSMEs and to service providers	Facilitate financial inclusion and Literacy of commercially oriented farmers and Agri-MSMEs	Develop Supportive and Inclusive Payment Infrastructure	Promote Responsible Finance
Increase individuals and Household Savings for Resilience	Support the implementation of Rwanda sustainable finance roadmap	Deepening Agricultural Financing Market	Develop fintech sector for inclusion	
Expand Access to Insurance for Risk Management		Scaling up the Agricultural Insurance Market	Explore a Central Bank Digital Currency (CBDC)	
		Coping with Climate change		

Cross Cutting

Enabling Environment

9. Implementation Structures

The proposed implementation structure for NFIR 2026 – 2030 is depicted in **Figure 14**. At the top a high level Inter Ministerial Steering committee will direct the NFIR implementation, and ensure that the necessary implementation resources, be they human, financial, or technical are available. The members of this committee will be at Ministerial Level, to ensure adequate support is provided to the process. The Committee will be supported by a financial inclusion Technical Committee that will on a day-to-day basis co-ordinate the implementation of the NFIR, with potential for creation of working groups as they deem fit. The technical committee will be comprised of key decision makers within the various implementing agencies. Both committees will be supported by a financial inclusion Secretariat, which is already established and located within the Financial Inclusion department of the NBR.

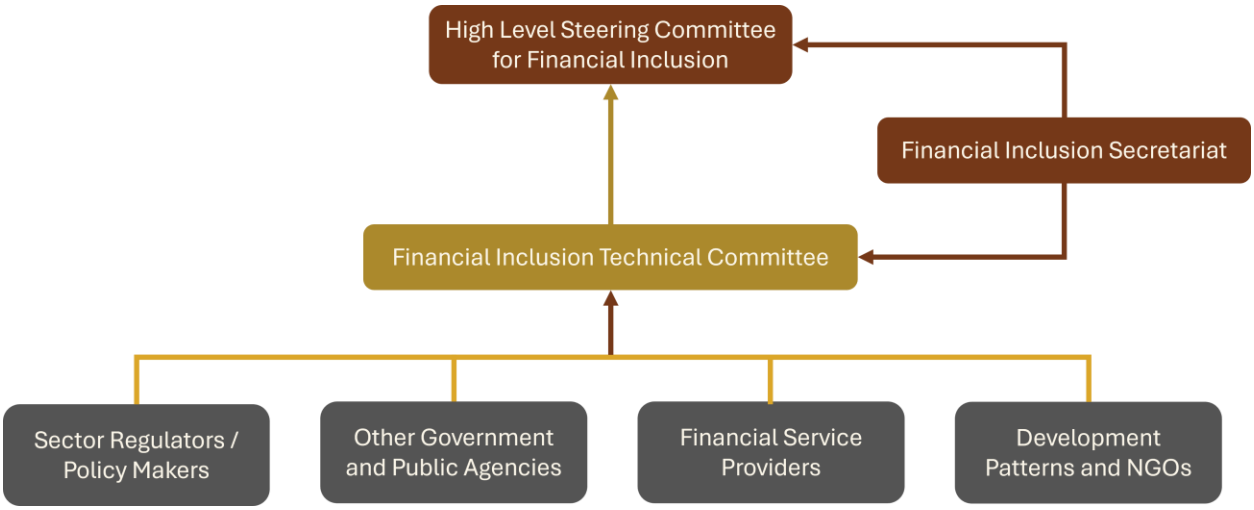


Figure 14: Proposed Implementation Structures

High Level Steering Committee for Financial Inclusion. As mentioned, implementation of the NFIR is overseen by a high-level Steering Committee for Financial Inclusion, which will be co-chaired by senior officials from the Ministry of Finance (MINECOFIN) and the Central Bank (NBR), proposed to be the state minister in charge of Economic Planning and the Deputy Governor of the Central Bank respectively. The Committee will meet annually or more often as needed. It will provide strategic direction for the implementation of various aspects of NFIR 2026 – 2030, make key strategic decisions impacting on more than one Ministry, and approve the annual Action Plan / Work Plan, and Annual Report of the NFIR 2026 – 2030. Membership will consist of State Ministers or Permanent Secretaries in the various implementing Ministries, including but not limited to MINECOFIN, NBR, MINAGRI, MINICOM, MIGEPROF, MOYA, MINALOC and MINICT. Other involved Ministries may also be invited depending on the topics to be discussed, including MINEDUC, MINEMA, MINIJUST and others. The NBR supported by AFR will be responsible for Minutes and follow up on any matters arising between meetings.

Financial Inclusion Technical Committee. There will also be a Technical Committee, which will meet semi-annually. Chaired by MINECOFIN (Head, Financial Sector Development) supported by vice-chair who will be the Executive Director Financial Sector Development and Conduct, the committee will co-ordinate the implementation of the NFIR Action Plan, ensuring that stakeholders report on progress and plans in their various areas against the Annual Work Plan, and ensure the collection and availability of financial inclusion data. This committee will also regularly (every 6 months) monitor the achievement of targets in the NFIR. Membership in the Committee will be at the discretion of the Co-Chairs, and can be expected to include the implementing Ministries and agencies, the private sector, and donors as follows:

- Regulator / Policy: MINECOFIN, NBR (Bank Supervision, Microfinance, Payments, Insurance & Pension, Financial Sector Conduct Supervision, Financial Inclusion and Statistics), CMA and RCA.
- Implementer Ministries: MINAGRI, MINICOM, MIGEPROF, MOYA, MINALOC and MINICT. Others by invitation: MINEDUC; MINEMA.
- Agencies: GMO
- Private Sector: RBA; AMIR; ASSAR; representative of EMIs; representative of other payments service providers; CRB and PSF chambers representatives
- Donors and development partners: AFR; UN Agencies; NGOs representative, etc.
- Other entities on invitation as required.

Financial Inclusion Secretariat. The High-Level Steering Committee and the Financial Inclusion Technical Committee will both be supported by the Financial Inclusion Secretariat, currently located at the NBR under the Director, Financial Inclusion. Staff from Financial Sector Development (MINECOFIN) will be part of the committee for assisting in monitoring and evaluation. Among its most important tasks the Secretariat will provide sufficient support such that the two Committees are able to engage respective implementation agencies to ensure continued progress in implementation. In addition, the FI Secretariat also:

- Ensures that financial inclusion continues to be prominent in policy debates, whether in other relevant Ministries or in the international forums.
- Ensures that financial inclusion imperatives are reflected in Government of Rwanda policy and regulatory decisions
- Coordinates with other departments in the development of policies that impact on financial inclusion (e.g., MINAGRI, MINICOM, MIGEPROF, MOYA, MINICT, MINALOC, GMO, etc.)
- Ensures the availability of financial inclusion data to orient informed decisions and creates a holistic financial inclusion data repository.
- Collects from within the Sector Regulators and Associations, key statistics on financial inclusion
- Leads and coordinates the compilation of data needed for monitoring and evaluation purposes.
- Ensures awareness and promotion of the financial inclusion agenda in the public space, including the dissemination of the NFIR among stakeholders

- Holds ongoing engagement with the stakeholder community, including the private sector, and ensures that the NFIR is regularly updated and relevant to national needs.

Implementation plans. It is important for the implementation process while being coordinated at the national level to be devolved to the agencies and sectors responsible for the implementation. The appointment and constitution of Working Groups will be finalised in the context of the implementation plan. The Secretariat in developing the detailed implementation plan will also consider the optimum involvement of various stakeholders in the process, including existing or new sub sector groups to address the various parts of the NFIR.

The Annual Work Plan of the NFIR 2026 – 2030 will outline the key activities to be completed during the year, while the Annual Report will highlight the achievements made during the year. While the Secretariat will prepare these documents, it will be on behalf of the High-level Steering Committee. An important component of the Annual Report will be the M&E report, which will highlight progress made during the year in terms of various indicators and suggest any change in direction that may be required to help achieve the objectives of the NFIR 2026 – 2030.

10. Risk Matrix – NFIR 2026 – 2030

A number of risks to the implementation of this strategy are foreseen, and potential mitigation strategies developed in Table 6. These risks will continue to be monitored by the Financial Inclusion Technical Committee, to ensure the success of the NFIR implementation. Among the major implementation dependencies is the need for funding of various elements of the NFIR, especially the modernisation needed in the SACCO / MFI environment, as well as technical support needed in various areas identified by the NFIR. This risk is much mitigated as these programmes have been in discussion for some time, and plans are advanced to implement these aspects of the NFIR. The support provided by AFR and other development partners is anticipated to continue.

Table 3: NFIR 2026 - 2030 risk matrix

Risks	Possible mitigation
Funding for key interventions especially the improvements needed in the MFI and SACCO sectors, and capacity building interventions	• Ensure ongoing donor and government support for financial inclusion • Encourage private sector development • Continue to mobilize domestic savings
Ensuring inclusion delivers on its promise – Successful transition from increase in access to impact of financial inclusion in people's lives	• Focus on usage and quality of financial services • Measurement of impact through FinScope survey and other tools • Continue focus on under developed sectors especially insurance

Sustainability of financial inclusion progress	• Continue to provide a supportive regulatory environment, including sandboxes to test new ideas • Service providers to continue to lead product innovation and customer literacy, so that the high rate of uptake is sustained
Lack of buy-in / compliance from key stakeholders	• Awareness and buy-in of the NFIR priorities and activities with key stakeholders including government, donors and private sector • Engage individual stakeholders with regular updates during implementation
Agriculture insurance remains a challenging area to implement yet it has so much potential to positively impact lives	• Focus on the ongoing pilots to ensure they receive all the necessary support and capacity; constant evaluation and tailoring / improving the programme to ensure it achieves its purpose.
Lack of interest by many who are currently included in the informal sector due to fear of taxation in the formal sector	• Coordinate with the tax authorities to ensure that those below the tax brackets understand taxation, and to encourage others to register for and to pay for taxes
Technical implementation risks	• Proper feasibility studies, planning and implementation
Rapid pace of change leading to duplication	• Comprehensive industry discussions at the correct levels • Centralized policy and implementation coordination at MINECOFIN
Lack of financial and human capacity for innovation by private sector players, especially in the insurance sector	• Capacity support by development partners, and regulatory intervention where necessary, but main reliance on market forces

11. Measurement and Results Monitoring

In this Chapter the measurement approach for the NFIR is proposed.

Purpose of M&E. Successful implementation depends on being able to measure progress, as well as communicating the outcomes of the interventions. The Secretariat will monitor and provide regular M&E reports which will help assess whether activities are implemented, and anticipated results are achieved.

Data collection. The Financial Inclusion Secretariat will be responsible for collecting M&E data, from existing sources within the NBR through the Financial Inclusion Dashboard, Finscope Surveys, other Regulators, Sector Associations, line Ministries and Development Partners. Continued engagement with stakeholders will be needed to ensure the collection of correctly defined data and to improve data collection timelines, as will be the ensuring of Secretariat capacity in collecting, managing, and reporting M&E data.

Mid-term evaluation of the NFIR 2026 - 2030. A mid-term evaluation of the NFIR will be carried out at the end of 2028.

Reporting intervals. The M&E framework will serve as the 'backbone" for the Secretariat NFIR management plan supported with a regular reporting system. Monitoring, assessment and measuring the results of NFIR implementation will be carried out at least every 6 months.

ANNEX 1. DETAILED ACTION PLAN

	Program / Subprogram/ Activity / Inputs	Implementing Agency	Timeline				
			2026	2026-2027	2027-2028	2028-2029	2029-2030
Pillar 1: Resilience & Money Management for Households							
1.1 Support informal savings and credit groups							
1.1.1. Linkages with formal sector i.e. SACCOs, EMIs, MFIs, and banks							
	Fasten the process of registering all savings and credit groups at sector level	Lead: MINECOFIN NGOs, MINALOC	X				
	Provide technical support for product development by formal financial sector providers to serve SCGs – transactions platforms and deposits / loan accounts, focusing on SACCOs, EMIs, MFIs and banks	Lead: AFR FSPs, NBR, NGOs, SCGs, MINECOFIN		X			
	Establish a simple, standardized reporting framework for SCGs and identify a data repository, providing easier opportunity to evaluate their performance by service providers	Lead: MINECOFIN AFR, NGOs, SCGs, NBR	X				
	Encourage SCGs to move cash savings to digital platforms (e.g. mobile money)	Lead: Fintechs NGOs, EMIs			X		
	Permit SCGs to open savings accounts at SACCOs as groups rather than members doing so individually, and group-based collateral / guarantor on loans, to encourage participation of the informal groups in the formal sector and increase visibility in the formal sector	Lead: NBR RCA, SACCOs		X			
	Update the SCG map on a regular (annual) basis, to help understand their contribution (volumes of savings and loans, financial education), and to inform future interventions in the saving group development; and broaden it to include semi-formal groups in the central reporting framework	Lead: NBR NGOs, MINECOFIN	X	X	X		
	1.1.2. Digitization of SCGs						
	Provide technical support for the installation of digital platforms to capture SCG transactions, using solutions from financial service providers, and fintechs	Lead: AFR NGOs, Fintechs, SCGs	X	X			
	1.1.3 Diversify products available to SCG members						

	Program / Subprogram/ Activity / Inputs	Implementing Agency	Timeline				
			2026	2026-2027	2027-2028	2028-2029	2029-2030
	Promote the adoption of formal financial services by SCG members, by sensitizing them to relevant formal financial services, especially micro insurance, pension, and agriculture insurance, working with SCG promoters to sensitize the communities	Lead: FSPs, MINAGRI, MINECOFIN, ASSAR, MINALOC		X			
1.2 Enhance Services from SACCOs and Microfinance Institutions							
	1.2.1 Consolidate and automate district SACCOs						
	Establish the Cooperative Bank, to provide a platform for SACCOs to engage / link with the broader market, manage SACCO liquidity, and host a shared services platform including a Core Banking System	Lead: MINECOFIN NBR, SACCOs, RCA, AMIR			X		
	Provide technical support for the institutional strengthening of D-SACCOs through the automation of systems and procedures, including core banking systems, to help them improve their management and operational systems, further supporting self-sustainability, improved record-keeping, and more effective supervision	Lead: AMIR SACCOs, AFR				X	
	Integrate the D-SACCOs into the national payment system, and develop services including payments and account linkages with the banks	Lead: RSWITCH SACCOS, AFR, AMIR, NBR		X			
	Develop a framework for syndicating loans between the District SACCOs and the National Cooperative Bank, to enable D-SACCOs to better meet members' needs for more / larger loans	Lead: MINECOFIN SACCOS, AMIR					X
	Provide technical support for product innovation to improve the range and relevance of products from D-SACCOs, including tailored savings products, children's savings accounts, larger loans, insurance, bundled products and affordable / cost-effective delivery channels like mobile banking	Lead: AFR AMIR, SACCOs		X			
	Strengthen the governance of the D-SACCOs by appointing to the governance structures of the consolidated units experienced and skilled financial services practitioners	Lead: RCA SACCOs, AMIR			X		
	Review the legal framework to reflect the above measures, including amending the cooperatives law	Lead: RCA MINICOM, RCA, MINECOFIN					X

Program / Subprogram/ Activity / Inputs	Implementing Agency	Timeline				
		2026	2026-2027	2027-2028	2028-2029	2029-2030
1.2.2 Enhance the governance, human resources, financial sustainability & capacity of D-SACCOs						
Identify gaps in skill and knowledge among SACCO staff, management and board, and design and fund capacity building programs to strengthen SACCO capacity.	Lead: AMIR AFR, SACCOs, NBR	X				
Establish mechanisms to facilitate, support and advocate for linkages between SACCOs and Banks / MFIs, to allow improved access to capital to better meet the demand of their clients.	Lead: NBR MINECOFIN, AFR		X			
1.3 Strengthen MFIs to provide more options for customers in rural areas						
1.3.1 Strengthen the MFI network						
Onboard all MFIs to be part of eKash	Lead: RSWTCH AMIR, MFIs, NBR		X			
Provide capacity support to improve quality of reporting by MFIs to credit reference bureau	Lead: TransUnion AFR, MFIs, NBR			X		
Improve MFIs product diversification to include micro-savings, micro-insurance, emergency loans, and digital savings plans.						
Build operational capacity of MFIs to deliver customer-centric, tech-enabled services	Lead: AMIR NBR		X			
Introduce performance-based incentives for MFIs that expand services to excluded groups	Lead: NBR MFIs, AMIR		X			
1.4 Increase individuals and Household Savings for Resilience						
1.4.1 Awareness and increased visibility of existing savings products						
Intensify marketing and awareness programs to encourage use of existing savings and investments vehicles i.e. LTSS and the collective investment scheme (RNIT), using common platforms for the government led initiatives to save costs	Lead: MINECOFIN LTSS EJOHEZA, RNIT, FSPs, NBR, AFR	X				
Implement education programs to encourage savings among the population and among school going children	Lead: MINEDUC MINECOFIN, NBR				X	

	Program / Subprogram/ Activity / Inputs	Implementing Agency	Timeline				
			2026	2026-2027	2027-2028	2028-2029	2029-2030
1.4.2 Development of relevant long-term savings products							
	Develop additional Unit trust type of product through both the public and private sector	Lead: MINECOFIN Insurers, ASSAR, PSF			X		
	Development of relevant accounts targeted at low-income consumers in the rural areas (MFIs and SACCOs and banks in partnership with mobile and SACCO operators)	Lead: AMIR MFIs, SACCOs, EMIs, AFR			X		
	Design and promote goal-based and commitment savings products for education, emergencies, and housing	Lead: RBA, AMIR FSPs, FINTECHS		X		X	
	Promote automated digital savings tools linked to mobile wallets and income flows.	Lead: RBA, AMIR, ASSAR FSPs, FINTECHs		X			
1.5 Expand Access to Insurance for Risk Management							
1.5.1 Increased Insurance product innovation							
	Provide technical support to increase product innovation in insurance, including non-life, life and bundled products e.g. inclusive insurance innovation fund	Lead: AFR ASSAR, Insurers, NBR		X			
	Provide technical support to enable digital insurance and broaden distribution channels, including support for product development, bundling and embedding strategies, and digital financial education strategies	Lead: AFR ASSAR, Insurers, NBR			X		
	Develop affordable micro-insurance products covering health, life, and emergencies.	Lead: Insurers ASSAR, AFR			X		
1.5.2 Insurance Sector development for increased innovation / penetration							
	Mobilize the sector to ensure insurance sector skills development, especially for actuarial scientists, and introduce insurance professional requirements	ASSAR			X		
	Develop insurance data hub at ASSAR to encourage industry development, best practices and innovation	Lead: ASSAR AFR, NBR			X		
	Develop linkages between Insurance companies and other financial institutions to act as insurance intermediaries/ agents	Lead: ASSAR Insurers and other FSPs			X		

		Program / Subprogram/ Activity / Inputs	Implementing Agency	Timeline				
				2026	2026-2027	2027-2028	2028-2029	2029-2030
		Partner with community institutions and employers to bundle insurance with other services (e.g., farmer cooperatives, savings groups)	Lead: Insurers ASSAR, AFR			X		
		Leverage mobile and fintech channels for distribution and claims processing	Lead: ASSAR AFR, NBR, Fintech Association		X			
Pillar 2: MSME Access to Finance for investment								
2.1 Stock taking and consolidation of existing interventions								
	2.1.1 Review of MSME interventions to ensure increased focus on uptake and quality							
		Conduct a strategic review of existing government interventions to increase credit extension to MSMEs, with particular focus on how to streamline existing initiatives and increase the role of the private sector to complement government.	Lead: MINICOM MINECOFIN, BRD, WBG		X			
		Improve existing mechanisms based on the review, with potential to develop new de-risking instruments to unlock capital for MSMEs, and an increased role for the private sector	Lead: MINICOM MINECOFIN, NBR, BRD		X			
2.2 Broaden available range of products / providers								
	2.2.1 Life cycle approach to finance for MSMEs							
		In conjunction with CMA, revamp, market and raise awareness around the alternative exchange, and the commodity exchange / warehouse receipts, especially in regard to how MSMEs can utilize them for finance	Lead: MINICOM CMA, FSPs			X		
		In conjunction with the CMA, identify and find ways to attract and exploit new sources of financing such as green bonds, crowdfunding and venture capital funds	Lead: MINICOFIN CMA, FSPs			X		
		In conjunction with MINICT, design and implement investor roadshows to attract new types of investors into the Rwanda MSME space, leveraging the MINICT innovation hubs	Lead: MINICT FINTECHS, MINICOM		X			
		Support private and donor-funded blended finance initiatives targeting MSMEs in key value chains	Lead: MINICOM MINICOFIN, NBR		X			

Program / Subprogram/ Activity / Inputs	Implementing Agency	Timeline				
		2026	2026-2027	2027-2028	2028-2029	2029-2030
2.2.2 Investment in emerging MSME finance approaches						
Continue to develop the value chain / sector approaches, focusing on all elements of the value chain including aggregators and processors, and the national priority value chains	Lead: MINICOM MINAGRI, RAB, RYAF, BRD			X		
Develop the leasing business, through new companies or within existing institutions, to serve the MSME market particularly with financing for equipment, vehicles and tractors	FSPs		X			
2.2.3 Enabling environment for MSME finance						
Adopt a legal framework for asset-based financing to address asset-backed financing, factoring, contract and cash flow lending	Lead: MINICOFIN NBR, MINICOM		X	X		
In conjunction with Ministry of Justice, address collateral realization challenges	Lead: MINIJUST NBR		X			
Establish special court procedures to deal with "small" loan defaults	Lead: MINIJUST NBR			X		
Review collateral valuation and registration fees and collateral recovery regulations to make more suited to low-value credits	RDB		X			
Explore the use of alternative data for credit scoring and lending	Lead: NBR MINECOFIN, AFR, RDB			X		
2.3 Capacity support to MSMEs and to service providers						
2.3.1 Capacity support to MSMEs to improve investment readiness						
Provide technical support to MSMEs to prepare investable business cases and funding applications, and for investment readiness to attract finance from investors	Lead: MINICOM Donors, FSPs		X	X		
Support MSMEs to access finance from the Capital Markets by strengthening their readiness and capacity to meet listing requirements.	Lead: MINICOM CMA				X	
Implement targeted innovation funds and hackathons to promote and finance innovation targeting women and men	Lead: MINICOM MINECOFIN, NGOs, BRD, AFR		X			
2.3.2 Capacity of Financial Institutions to lend to MSMEs						

		Program / Subprogram/ Activity / Inputs	Implementing Agency	Timeline				
				2026	2026-2027	2027-2028	2028-2029	2029-2030
		Implement the WE Finance Code Plan	Lead: NBR, AFR, MINECOFIN, RBA, AMIR FSPs	X	X			
		Expand lending to MSMEs and for special groups (MSMEs, Women, Youth), through targeted financial institution funding windows, and strengthening the capacity of staff	FSPs				X	
		Provide technical assistance to banks and non-bank institutions (MFIs, SACCOs, specialized finance providers) to expand lending to MSMEs and agribusiness, by developing products targeted at MSMEs – trade finance, working capital, cross border products, etc.	Lead: AFR MINICOM, MINECOFIN, BRD		X			
		Provide capacity support to financial institutions to expand leasing products targeted at MSMEs particularly for product development and roll out strategy	Lead: NBR AFR, FSPs		X			
		Provide capacity support for use of alternative data (to develop early stage MSME focused products)	Lead: NBR MINECOFIN, FSPs, FINTECH, AFR		X			
		Provide capacity support to banks to make greater use of guarantee certificates as collateral as they are not sufficiently trusted by commercial banks	Lead: CMA FSPs			X		
		Improve CRB efficiency in respect of linking records across lost/ replacement IDs, so that credit records in case of replacements are linked across the old and new ID numbers	Lead: TransUnion NIDA			X		
	2.3.3 Linkages between access to finance initiatives and broader MSME programs							
		Explore ways to strengthen linkages with existing Entrepreneurship programs - Sector and value chain-based education	Lead: MOYA INKOMOKO				X	
		Explore ways to strengthen linkages with existing Innovation hubs	Lead: MINICT MINICOM, PSF				X	
		Explore ways to strengthen linkages with existing EPZ / Industrial parks	MINICOM				X	
2.4 Support the implementation of the Rwanda Sustainable Finance Roadmap								
	2.4.1 Mobilize capital towards a green and inclusive economy							

Program / Subprogram/ Activity / Inputs	Implementing Agency	Timeline				
		2026	2026-2027	2027-2028	2028-2029	2029-2030
Provide capacity for banks to develop green loan programs for MSMEs, with support of BRD in form of targeted guarantee schemes	Lead: NBR MoE, NGOs, MINICOM, BRD, FSP, FONERWA				X	
Provide capacity to the stock market to develop green bonds, and potentially a green index	Lead: CMA, AFR, BRD, RSE, PSF, RFL				X	
Introduce green blended finance instruments, drawing on public institutional investment vehicles and integrating green finance considerations, and pioneer issuance of green bonds	Lead: CMA FSPs, Development partners, RSE, RFL			X		
Expand mobile payment-based products that support increased uptake of distributed renewable energy	Lead: EMIs Fintechs, EMIs, REG, FSPs		X			
Attract international green finance, through the establishment of necessary standards, indices and products, in conjunction with FONERWA and the Stock market	Lead: RFL FONERWA, RSE		X			
2.4.2 Environmental sustainability in decision making						
Engage development partners to encourage environment sustainability throughout their various interventions in financial inclusion, and green finance	Lead: RFL NBR, Development partners				X	
Provide technical capacity support to sector providers to mainstream sustainable development factors across financial decision-making	Development partners			X		
Pillar 3: Access to Finance for investment & resilience for farmers						
3.1 Strengthen the Agri finance data / information environment						
3.1.1 Demand and supply side data for Agri sector						
Incorporate financial inclusion questions into the major surveys that cover farmers and Agri-enterprises	Lead: MINAGRI NBR, MINAGRI, Development partners	X				
Strengthen the quality of supply-side data on agriculture finance and publicly publish data disaggregated by subsectors, client groups, and geographic regions, and by gender, products, tenor of financing, etc.	Lead: NBR, FSPs, MINAGRI			X		

Program / Subprogram/ Activity / Inputs	Implementing Agency	Timeline				
		2026	2026-2027	2027-2028	2028-2029	2029-2030
Create a directory of agribusiness enterprises to provide self-reported financial data on the enterprises to serve as the first point of credit analysis for financial institutions.	Lead: MINAGRI MINICOM			X		
3.2 Develop an agriculture lending infrastructure						
3.2.1 Map farmer credit user journey	Lead: NBR, MNICT & MINAGRI Other: AFR, RISA					
Diagnose supply and demand side challenges/journeys						
Obtain a baseline assessment of digitization levels in the financial sector						
3.2.2 Define credit decision data points						
Map out key government and private data points						
Approval of the Agriculture Lending platform business case						
3.2.3 Build and test a data exchange layer						
Design and build the Agriculture Lending platform						
Pilot the Agriculture Lending platform						
Establish a stabilization and scaling plan for the platform						
3.3 Facilitate financial inclusion and literacy of commercially oriented farmers and Agri-MSMEs						
3.3.1 Strengthen producer cooperatives and their federations						
Provide capacity support to strengthen operations and facilitate business transparency of producer SACCOs and their federations, through enhanced skills, professional management, enhanced transparency and installation of information systems	Lead: AFR Producer SACCOs				X	
Provide capacity support for the introduction of digitized products for farmers	Lead: MINAGRI AFR, EMIs, Fintechs				X	
3.3.2 Facilitate digitization of Agri sector payments						
Facilitate electronic payments in commercial transactions of agricultural commodities, by encouraging use of electronic payments by agribusinesses.	Lead: MINAGRI MINECOFIN, FSPs, Fintechs			X		

Program / Subprogram/ Activity / Inputs	Implementing Agency	Timeline				
		2026	2026-2027	2027-2028	2028-2029	2029-2030
Use of electronic payments in public income support programs targeting farmers.	Lead: LODA MINALOC, Fintechs	X				
Assess the feasibility and benefit of digitizing the GoR inputs subsidy scheme.	Lead: LODA MINALOC		X			
3.3.3 Financial literacy of farmers						
Bundle financial education with other capacity building initiatives such as agricultural extension	Lead: MINAGRI MINECOFIN			X		
3.4 Deepening the Agricultural Financing Market						
3.4.1 Operational capacity of Agri sector providers						
Technical support to strengthen the operational capacity of commercial banks, MFIs, and district SACCOs to provide financial services to agriculture sector clients, by scaling up existing support initiatives, and considering incentives such as fiscal incentives, credit guarantees or other subsidies for providers	Lead: NBR RRA, AMIR, ASSAR, RBA, MINECOFIN, AFR,				X	
Enhance awareness and capacity of providers to implement existing financing models including warehouse receipt systems, invoice discounting, structured trade finance, and leasing schemes, cash flow-based financing and embedded value chain financing	Lead: MINECOFIN NBR, AFR			X		
3.4.2 Role of BRD in the agriculture sector						
Assess the impact of the BRD's role as market makers in agriculture finance to ensure the grant and guarantee programs have systemic impact on the number of benefitting enterprises	Lead: MINECOFIN BRD, MINAGRI. MINICOM		X			
Strengthen BRD operations in general and enhance its agriculture sector domain knowledge and analytical capacity.	Lead: BRD MINICOM, MINAGRI, RAB, MINECOFIN			X		
Strengthen BRD partnership with FSPs to advance lending to the agriculture sector	BRD, NBR, FSPs			X		
3.5 Scaling Up the Agriculture Insurance Market						
3.5.1 Agri insurance pilot implementation and expansion						

Program / Subprogram/ Activity / Inputs	Implementing Agency	Timeline				
		2026	2026-2027	2027-2028	2028-2029	2029-2030
Implement ongoing agricultural insurance crop and livestock insurance pilots	Lead: AFR MINAGRI, INSURERS		X	X		
Build awareness on the agricultural insurance intervention	Lead: MINECOFIN NBR, ASSAR		X			
Enhance technical capacity and expertise among key entities participating in the national scale-up efforts, and awareness and understanding about the benefits of agricultural insurance among farmers and other stakeholders	Lead: AFR ASSAR, MINAGRI		X			
Assess the pilot progress and expand / amend as necessary, including reviewing the need for the initial subsidies as scale is gained	Lead: MINAGRI MINECOFIN			X		
Consider removing reinsurance tax on insurance premiums to reduce customer costs	RRA			X		
3.5.2 Strengthen the quality of agricultural and weather data						
Collect and report production statistics at a more granular level than the current level of Agri-ecological zones to make it more useful for area yield-based insurance products, possibly allowing registered private companies with specialist skills in yield estimation to provide production statistics	MINAGRI			X		
In conjunction with MINAGRI, explore the viability of commissioning regular (e.g., annual or biannual) surveys to collect data on livestock mortality statistics to be used by providers of livestock insurance in assessing the level of risk involved	Lead: MINAGRI RAB, NAEB			X		
Expand the density of automated weather stations and make the ground-based rainfall data available to potential providers of weather-based insurance products	MINAGRI			X		
Engage researchers and providers of ground-based weather stations and satellite-based weather data, to provide data for claims management to fill the spatial and historical gaps	MINAGRI				X	
Create linkages to other public agricultural support programs	MINAGRI		X			
3.5.3 Establish an agriculture data platform						

	Program / Subprogram/ Activity / Inputs	Implementing Agency	Timeline				
			2026	2026-2027	2027-2028	2028-2029	2029-2030
	Establish an agriculture data platform incorporating various existing data, e.g. number of farms, crops produced, land ownership and usage, crop yield, usage of inputs, and degree of mechanization, and currently missing data (rainfall, livestock mortality data, etc.) and proactively disseminate them to a wider audience.	MINAGRI			X		
3.6 Coping with climate change							
3.6.1 Support farmers to cope with climate change impact							
	Develop products (especially credit) to support farmers to increase climate sensitive approaches, and to help in coping with climate change e.g. irrigation finance	Lead: FSPs MINAGRI		X			
	Provide mechanisms for low-income rural population for disaster resilience, i.e. agriculture insurance and micro insurance products	Lead: INSURERS ASSAR, MINAGRI		X	X		
Pillar 4: Expansion of Digital Financial Services							
4.1 Increased use of digital financial services							
4.1.1 Supportive environment for uptake of DFS							
	Facilitate remote, digital account opening	Lead: FSPs FSPs, EMIs, Fintechs	X				
	Advocate trust building and awareness building programs for the use of digital payments.	FSPs and EMIs		X			
	Develop service level standards to ensure good market practice in terms of transparency and customer redress in DFS	Lead: NBR FSPs		X			
	Establish Payments Association to provide a forum to articulate industry views	Lead: PSPs					
	Payment Service Providers develop cross-border payments infrastructure to support integrated regional payments system						
4.1.2 Broadening the range of available DFS use cases							
	Provide capacity support for service providers to develop innovative DFS products	Lead: AFR FSPs		X			

	Program / Subprogram/ Activity / Inputs	Implementing Agency	Timeline				
			2026	2026-2027	2027-2028	2028-2029	2029-2030
	Encourage the development of diaspora focused products on DFS platforms, including targeted low-cost remittance, investment and long-term savings products	Lead: MINECOFIN RRA, NBR, RNIT, CMA, FSPs			X		
4.1.3 Catalyze demand for DFS services							
	Ensure that customer touchpoints (banking agents, EMI agents and SACCO outlets) are well trained and well supplied to provide help to customers using DFS	Lead: MINECOFIN NBR, AFR, AMIR, RBA, ASSAR			X		
	Deploy an effective, structured, quality, shared agency banking network infrastructure across the country to support agent network growth	Lead: Rswitch FSPs, AFR			X		
	Review the taxation policies regarding e-payment transactions to encourage usage, and explore possible disincentives to the use of cash	Lead: RRA MINECOFIN			X		
	Embed digital financial literacy in national strategies for the financial sector.	Lead: MINECOFIN NBR, FSPs, RFL, MINICT, RISA, MINALOC.		X			
4.2 Promote Open Finance and Data sharing frameworks							
4.2.1 Building the open finance ecosystem		Lead: NBR, FSPs					
	Develop Open Finance Guidelines	Lead: NBR, FSPs	X				
	Establish API standards in the market	Lead: NBR, FSPs	X				
	Establish National Open Finance Governance	Lead: FSPs, NBR, MINICT, Rswitch	X				
4.2.2. Implementation of Open finance		Lead: FSPs, NBR		X	X		
	Implement data sharing for tier 1 financial institutions in line with open finance guidelines	Lead: FSPs, NBR		X	X		
	Define a regulatory framework to Third Party Providers (TPPs)	Lead: NBR, NCSA		X	X		
	Expanding the data sharing regime to all FSPs	Lead: FSPs, NBR				X	
	Strengthen NBR'S oversight capacity on open finance	Lead: FSPs, NBR				X	

Program / Subprogram/ Activity / Inputs	Implementing Agency	Timeline				
		2026	2026-2027	2027-2028	2028-2029	2029-2030
Establish a TPPs license and supervisory frameworks	Lead: NBR, NCSA					X
Strengthen a Data sharing infrastructure	FSPs, NBR, MINICT, Rswitch					X
4.3 Develop supportive and Inclusive payment infrastructure						
4.3.1 Implement RNDPS 2						
Drive adoption of P2P and P2B	Lead: RSWITCH MINECOFIN, MINICT, RBA, AMIR, NBR, AFR, FSPs			X		
Support development and implementation of P2G, Bulk payments, B2B, and agent aggregation.	Lead: RSWITCH FSPs, AFR MINECOFIN, MINICT, RBA, AMIR, NBR, AFR				X	
Ensure easy access and affordability of eKash	Lead: RSWITCH MINECOFIN, MINICT, RBA, AMIR, NBR, AFR, FSPs		X			
4.4 Develop fintech sector for inclusion						
4.4.1 Support the implementation of the fintech strategy to drive financial inclusion						
Enhance regulatory guidance and clarity to the fintech sector	Lead: NBR and CMA	X				
Facilitate fintech integration to National Payments infrastructure	Lead: NBR, Rswitch			X		
Support the establishment of a National Fintech Hub	Lead: RFL, ICT Chamber, Fintech Association			X		
Leverage the regulatory sandbox to promote inclusive fintech solutions	Lead: NBR, Fintech Association	X				
4.5 Explore a Central Bank Digital Currency (CBDC) for Rwanda						
4.5.1 Pilot a CBDC in Rwanda						
Test inclusive CBDC user access methodologies and tools	Lead: NBR, FSPs, RSwitch, MINICT, MINALOC		X			

		Program / Subprogram/ Activity / Inputs	Implementing Agency	Timeline				
				2026	2026-2027	2027-2028	2028-2029	2029-2030
		Study and test instant, efficient with offline capabilities system architecture and technology	Lead: NBR, FSPs, MINICT		X			
		Test financial sector integration and market readiness	Lead: NBR, FSPs, MINICT			X		
		Conduct user tests and collect feedback	Lead: NBR, FSPs, RSwitch, MINICT, MINALOC			X		
Pillar 5: Strengthen Financial Health								
5.1 Promote Financial literacy and Capability								
	5.1.1 Coordination of financial literacy interventions							
		Continue / strengthen the coordination umbrella for financial literacy under MINECOFIN to ensure best use of resources.	Lead: MINECOFIN NBR, MINALOC, MIGEPROF, MOYA, MINICT, MINICOM, FSPs	X				
		Develop a National Financial Education Strategy (NFES)	Lead: MINECOFIN NBR		X			
		Carry out mid-term assessment (MTA) of financial education programs under the NFES to determine effectiveness and improve content and targeting, and refine as necessary	Lead: MINECOFIN NBR		X	X		
	5.1.2 Sector based financial literacy interventions							
		Scale-up Financial Education through SACCOs program.	Lead: MINECOFIN NBR		X			
		Implement sector based financial literacy and awareness intervention for Insurance, investment and pension products	Lead: ASSAR, CMA MINECOFIN, NBR		X			
		Implement sector based financial literacy intervention for digital financial services	MINECOFIN, NBR		X			
		Implement sector based financial literacy intervention for rural areas through SCGs	Lead: NGOs MINECOFIN, MINALOC, NBR		X			

Program / Subprogram/ Activity / Inputs	Implementing Agency	Timeline				
		2026	2026-2027	2027-2028	2028-2029	2029-2030
Ensure successful implementation of financial education curriculum in primary and secondary schools	Lead: MINEDUC MINECOFIN, NBR, REB, NESA			X		
Implement mechanisms to coordinate financial literacy campaigns	Lead: NBR MINECOFIN	X	X			
5.1.3 Relevant content design						
Ensure relevant content, including good practices and behavior change leading to financial health	Lead: NBR MINECOFIN			X		
5.2 Strengthen Consumer protection Frameworks						
5.2.1 Enforce the Financial Consumer Protection Framework						
Enforce the implementation of financial service consumer protection law	NBR	X	X			
Develop consumer protection tools to facilitate financial service consumers	NBR	X				
5.2.2 Strengthen consumer protection institutions and processes						
Enhance the use of Intumwa Chatbot for consumer grievances and complaint resolution	Lead: NBR FSPs, MINECOFIN		X			
Establish financial service consumer complaints committee	Lead: MINECOFIN	X				
Ensure each financial institution has adopted a code of conduct as per consumer protection legal and regulatory framework.	Lead: NBR			X		
5.3 Promote responsible finance						
5.3.1 Ensure FSPs deliver responsible finance						
Ensure FSPs deliver responsible finance as per NBR Guidelines	Lead: FSPs NBR,RBA, AMIR		X			
Create awareness to financial service customers on responsible finance (prevention of over indebtedness, predatory lending, fraud etc.)	Lead: FSPs NBR, RBA, AMIR		X			
Collect data on financial health indicators	Lead: FSPs		X			

Program / Subprogram/ Activity / Inputs	Implementing Agency	Timeline				
		2026	2026-2027	2027-2028	2028-2029	2029-2030
	NBR					
5.3 Additional segment specific measures						
5.3.1 Additional measures to address Rural excluded populations						
Conduct market research to support segmentation and product development for the excluded population	Lead: MINECOFIN NBR			X		
Implement / expand rural financial education targeted at the excluded	Lead: NBR MINECOFIN, FSPs			X		
5.3.2 Additional measures to address Women and youth inclusion						
Develop women and youth centric financial products	Lead: FSPs AFR, NBR			X		
Increase availability of gender and age sensitive data, and tracking of progress	Lead: NBR NISR, MIGEPROF, MOYA	X				
Implement targeted financial literacy aimed at youth and women	Lead: NBR MINECOFIN, MIGEPROF, MOYA		X			
Create incentives for FSPs to serve women, youth, and MSMEs	Lead: NBR FSPs		X			
5.3.3 Measures to address inclusion of Refugees						
Develop refugee centric products	Lead: MINEMA AFR, MINEMA, FSPs		X			
Digitize / expand digitization of refugee cash-based assistance (e.g. WFP/UNCHR)	Lead: MINEMA Donors, development Partners, FSPs	X				
5.3.3 Measures to address inclusion of persons with disabilities						
Sensitize financial service providers to the needs of persons with disabilities e.g. implement special support contact points in branches to deal with queuing, braille translation, etc.	Lead: NBR UNDP, FSPs, NUDOR	X				

		Program / Subprogram/ Activity / Inputs	Implementing Agency	Timeline				
				2026	2026-2027	2027-2028	2028-2029	2029-2030
		Work with the National Union of Disability Organizations in Rwanda to collect more information on statistics and challenges for people with disabilities in the financial sector including through FinScope survey	Lead: NUDOR UNDP, AFR, NBR		X			
		Support financial institutions to develop products for persons with disabilities	Lead: MINECOFIN UNDP, AFR, NUDOR, NBR		X			
		Develop and implement financial literacy programs for persons with disabilities	Lead: NBR MINECOFIN, NUDOR, UNDP, AFR		X			
6. Cross cutting								
6.1 Enabling Regulatory environment								
	6.1.1 Financial inclusion coordination and M&E							
		Set up the NFIR implementation structures (High level Steerco, Technical Working Group)	Lead: MINECOFIN NBR	X				
		Update M&E Framework including baseline and targets (i.e. after 2024 FinScope)	NBR	X				
		Implement systematic Stakeholder coordination and awareness mechanism, including regular meeting schedule	Lead: MINECOFIN NBR	X				
	6.1.2 Cross cutting regulatory enhancements							
		Implement regular collaboration forum for all regulators in the sector, including NBR, RCA, and other – within or outside the financial inclusion implementation coordination structure	NBR, RCA	X				
		Shift regulatory focus on AML to transaction size not account values	NBR			X		
	6.1.3 Financial inclusion roadmap or targets at each sector association, within existing annual plans							
		RBA develops financial inclusion targets for the bank sector in consultation with NBR	Lead: RBA Banks, NBR	X				
		ASSAR develops financial inclusion targets for the insurance sector in consultation with NBR	Lead: ASSAR Insurers	X				

		Program / Subprogram/ Activity / Inputs	Implementing Agency	Timeline				
				2026	2026-2027	2027-2028	2028-2029	2029-2030
		AMIR develops financial inclusion targets for the micro finance sector in consultation with NBR	Lead: AMIR MFIs, SACCOs	X				
	6.1.4 Enhanced sector data; capacity building for increased data utilization							
		Enhance the financial inclusion dashboard to reflect NFIR indicators/ data	NBR	X				
		Conduct regular Consumer FinScope survey (every 4 years), the next being in 2028	Lead: AFR MINECOFIN, NBR, NISR				X	
		More widely disseminate the FinScope dataset among banks, insurers, EMIs, etc., for market understanding and product development	Lead: NBR AFR, MINECOFIN				X	
		Implement capacity building for data for Secretariat and key regulators to ensure availability of regular, reliable, and gender / age sensitive sector data (insurance, microfinance, payments, banks, SACCOs, etc.)	Lead: NBR MINECOFIN		X			
		Avail Supply Side data to measure financial inclusion level	Lead: NBR FSPs	X				

ANNEX 2. M&E FRAMEWORK

NFIR M&E Indicators							
#	Outcome	Indicator	Units	Baseline	Target	Responsible for reporting	Data sources
NFIR level indicators – overall							
1	Increase formal financial inclusion	Formal financial inclusion	Percent	87.7%	95%	NBR	Financial Inclusion Dashboard
2	Increase insurance uptake	Insured adults	Percent	7.5%	15%	NBR	Financial Inclusion Dashboard
3	Breadth of usage i.e. Multiple formal product usage	Adults accessing >1 formal product category	Percent	41%	65%	NBR	FinScope
4	Women formally included	Women accessing formal financial services	Percent	80.2%	87%	NBR	Financial Inclusion Dashboard
5	Youth formally included	Youth accessing formal financial services	Percent	51.9%	60%	NBR	Financial Inclusion Dashboard
Women and youth high level indicators							
6	Parity between men and women formal inclusion	Women accessing at least 1 formal product	Percent	80%	95%	NBR	Financial Inclusion Dashboard
7	Women have increased formal credit options	Women with access to formal credit	Percent	9.4%	20%	NBR	Financial Inclusion Dashboard
8	Women have increased formal savings options	Women with access to formal savings	Percent	23.5%	50%	NBR	Financial Inclusion Dashboard
9	Youth have increased formal savings options	Youth (16 – 30) with access to formal savings	Percent	22.6%	30%	NBR	Financial Inclusion Dashboard

10	Youth have increased formal credit options	Youth (16 – 30) access to formal credit	Percent	8.8%	12%	NBR	Financial Inclusion Dashboard
Usage							
11	Usage of deposit accounts	% of adults with deposit accounts	Percent	48.1	52	NBR	Financial Inclusion Dashboard
12	Usage of loan accounts	% of adults with loan in formal institution	Percent	12.7	20	NBR	Financial Inclusion Dashboard
MSMEs							
13	Reach of formal credit among MSMEs	Percent of MSME owners with access to credit	Percent	44%	65%	FIS	FinScope
14	Reach of formal and informal remittances among MSMEs	Percent of MSME owners with access to remittances	Percent	65%	80%	FIS	FinScope
Digital Financial Services							
15	Reach of DFS	Percent of adults using DFS	Percent	66%	80%	FIS	FinScope
16	Reach of formal transactions	Percent of adults using formal payment transactions products, men / women	Percent	43%	80%	FIS	FinScope
17	Usage of mobile money	% of active mobile money users	Percent	68.5%	80%	NBR	Financial Inclusion Dashboard
Financial health							
18	Knowledge about financial services	Percent of adults aware of insurance; or percent of adults who do not know about insurance / do not know how it works / do not know how to get it (men, women)	Percent	71.4%	85%	FIS	FinScope
19	Digital literacy	Digital literacy for all youth (16 to 30 years)	Percent	TBA	60%	MINECOFIN	MINECOFIN

20	Saving	Percent with savings skills	Percent	14%	50%	FIS	FinScope
21	Financially Healthy	% of adults who are financially healthy	Percent	10%	20%	FIS	FinScope
22	Financially Coping	% of adults who are financially coping	Percent	57%	70%	FIS	FinScope
23	Financially Vulnerable	% of adults who are financially vulnerable	Percent	31%	10%	FIS	FinScope
24	Extremely Financially Vulnerable	% of adults who are extremely financially vulnerable	Percent	3%	0%	FIS	FinScope